

PUBLIC SUBMISSION

As of: March 21, 2025
Received: March 14, 2025
Status: [REDACTED]
Tracking No. m89-8t3o-tf64
Comments Due: March 15, 2025
Submission Type: API

Docket: NSF_FRDOC_0001
Recently Posted NSF Rules and Notices.

Comment On: NSF_FRDOC_0001-3479
Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

Document: NSF_FRDOC_0001-DRAFT-1445
Comment on FR Doc # 2025-02305

Submitter Information

Email: [REDACTED]
Government Agency Type: Local
Government Agency: Los Angeles County Chief Sustainability Office

General Comment

See attached file(s)

Attachments

AI Action Plan Comment Letter 3-15-25

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March 15, 2025

Faisal D'Souza
National Coordination Office
2415 Eisenhower Ave.
Alexandria, VA 22314

Re: Request for Information on the Development of an Artificial
Intelligence (AI) Action Plan

Dear Mr. D'Souza,

The County of Los Angeles Chief Sustainability Office respectfully writes in strong support of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan that prioritizes reducing AI's energy consumption and increasing energy and water efficiency. This document is approved for public dissemination. The document contains no business-proprietary or confidential information. Document contents may be reused by the government in developing the AI Action Plan and associated documents without attribution.

As AI continues to advance, its growing energy demands must be addressed through strategic policy action. Implementing energy-efficient practices, such as optimizing computing workloads and utilizing low-power hardware, will significantly reduce unnecessary energy use and lower emissions. Without intervention, AI's escalating energy demands could undermine our broader sustainability efforts. According to a study, by the year 2030, data centers may be responsible for up to 21 percent of the overall global energy demand when accounting for the cost of delivering AI to customers¹. Moreover, the negative effects of AI on grid reliability are a concern. AI data centers require significant power, and its continuous energy use could increase peak load stress, making the grid more susceptible to not being able to deliver energy to all who rely on it, not just AI data centers.

A key policy action in the AI Action Plan should be the transition of AI infrastructure to 100 percent renewable energy sources, such as solar and wind, ensuring net-zero emissions across all AI-related operations. Data centers and cloud computing facilities must actively mitigate their carbon footprint by integrating energy storage solutions, improving cooling technologies, and participating in clean energy procurement programs. Strong regulatory measures and incentives will drive the adoption of sustainable AI practices while

¹ [AI has high data center energy costs — but there are solutions | MIT Sloan](#)

fostering innovation in energy-efficient AI development. By embedding energy efficiency and clean energy use as core principles of AI policy, we can harness AI's potential without compromising our climate goals and commitments.

Lastly, the impact AI can have on water demand and usage and energy affordability must be carefully managed through sustainable practices and responsible policies. Given that AI requires significant computational power and that data centers can consume large amounts of electricity, energy costs for consumers, particularly those in areas with significant AI infrastructure, may face increased energy costs. Energy costs in California have increased significantly over the past several years², outpacing the rate of inflation by some measures. Additionally, data centers for cooling purposes also consume significant amounts of water. Utilizing water-conscious cooling solutions, including air-based cooling mechanisms, can help reduce the dependence on water and decrease the strain on water resources. Overall, avoiding unnecessary or wasteful AI applications and user education could be solutions to the potential problems of grid reliability, water demand, and energy affordability.

Thank you for your consideration. Should you have any questions regarding this letter, please contact me at [REDACTED]

Sincerely,

Rita Kampalath, Ph.D., P.E.
Chief Sustainability Officer
County of Los Angeles

² [Rising Electricity Rates in California](#)